

Rescue me

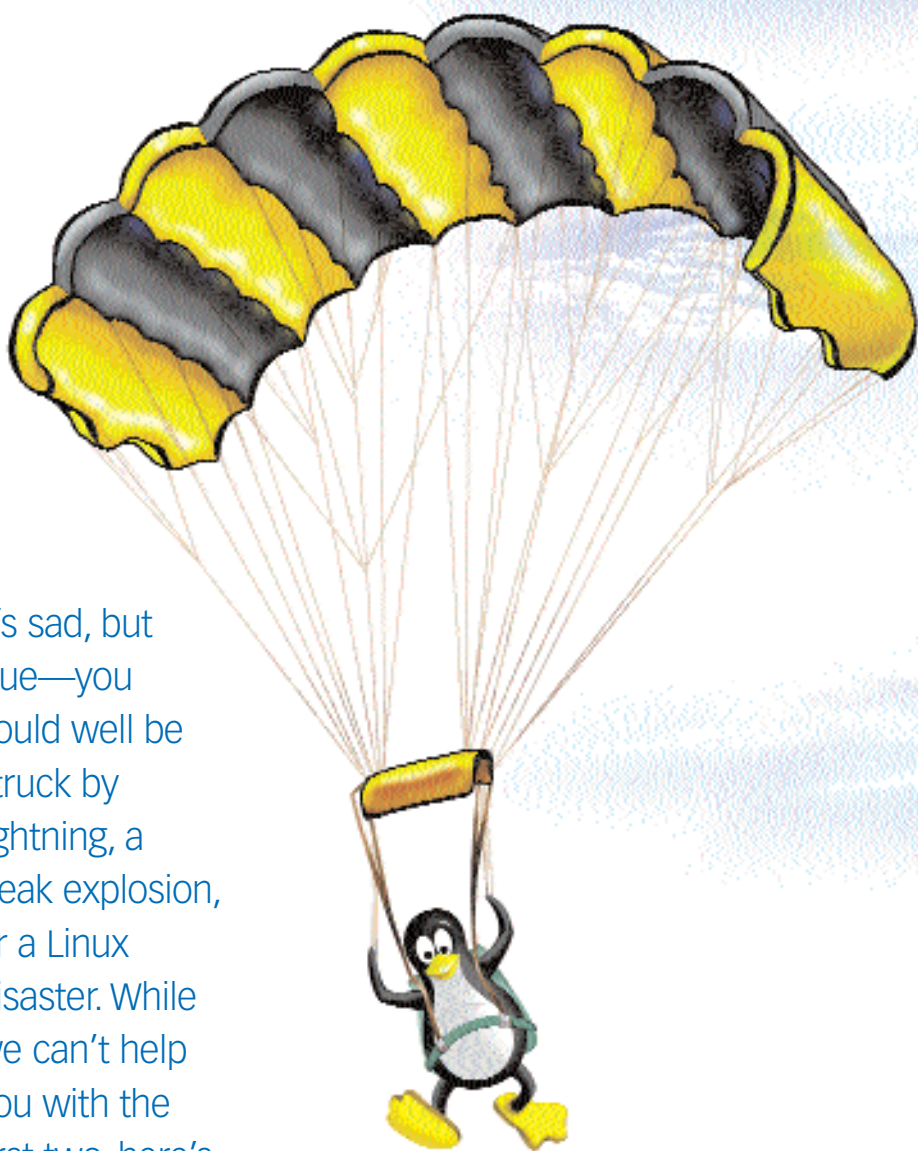
Reliability is a comforting thought; switching to Linux just reinforces this. Your Linux box packs in a fantastic desktop, more utilities than you can use, and the satisfaction of running a perfectly stable system. Almost.

You wouldn't be reading this if you hadn't faced the odd Linux problem, and while the chances of you seeing your Linux box fizzle into smoke are remote, like any good scout or guide, always be prepared.

Don't wait around to let disaster jump up on you. Never forget to:

- Regularly back up all your data. There is no substitute for a good backup.
- Make boot diskettes for your Linux, as well as your Windows system if you're dual-booting. It's better to be prepared for both the devil and the deep blue sea.
- Test your backup and boot diskettes regularly. You don't want to be left with coasters in your moment of despair.
- Keep your Red Hat CDs readily accessible. After all, they're CDs, not servants at your beck and call!
- You can make a bootable Knoppix 3.1 CD from the ISO on the *Digit Linux* Special DVD distributed in August 2003 (www.knoppix.org is the official Web site, and the current downloadable version is 3.4)
- Make backups of driver CDs and any new drivers you've downloaded.

It's sad, but true—you could well be struck by lightning, a freak explosion, or a Linux disaster. While we can't help you with the first two, here's how to tackle the last



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